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CONFIDENTIAL
1030/112/52.

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BRITISH EMBASSY,
TOKYO.

23rd June, 1952.

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Dear Department, (F 10310/85

Our letter 1030/110/52 of 6th June about Japan's relations with Nationalist China (not copied to Washington or Peking).

2. Statements made in the Foreign Affairs Committee of the Upper House this week have not helped to make the Japanese Government's position any clearer although they have tended to bring Japan still more into line with the United States' position.

3. The Chief of the Asian Affairs Bureau and the Chief of the Treaties Bureau of the Japanese Ministry for Foreign Affairs have both stated that the conclusion of a Peace Treaty with Communist China is legally impossible as the Peace Treaty with Nationalist China signifies that a state of war between Japan and the whole of China has ceased to exist. Mr. Okazaki, the Foreign Minister, has indicated that he shares these views. The position is, however, extremely confused and it is by no means impossible that someone else may soon come out with an "authoritative" statement to the contrary. The general attitude of the press is that it is time the Yoshida Government made up its mind.

4. We are sending copies of this letter to the Chanceries at Washington and Peking, and to the Consulate at Tamsui.

Yours ever,

CHANCERY

Japan and Pacific Department,
Foreign Office,
London, S.W.1.

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FO 371/99405
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